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Pictured here is the HP 15 AF001AX, but the HP 15 AC030TX looks exactly similar to its Best Buy Award winning brethren. Both laptops dress themselves pretty well.

under 2 kg – the 14-inch laptop actually ends up being the best looking machine in our comparison test, at least to our eyes. It's not only good looking but is also well-built, despite being a budget laptop, and that says a lot – we wouldn't expect anything else from a Lenovo laptop anyways. Though it lacks a dedicated number pad as some other 15-inch laptops in this test, the Lenovo U41's keyboard sports curved keys that are great for typing, and for typing alone this laptop is simply the best among all laptops here.

The Lenovo U41 offers a decent feature set and a good collection of pre-installed software, too – no bloatware in there, all good stuff that you will find useful. While it barely does a good job in multitasking with day-to-day apps, the overall performance of the Lenovo U41-70 isn't greatest among all laptops tested for this comparison – in fact, it's the lowest. However, like we said, nothing's really wrong with it, and if you want a lightweight 14-inch budget laptop that's easily carried around, that can turn heads with its attractive-



The Lenovo U41-70 is a great laptop for ultraportable fans, as it's easy to take around due to its lightweight.

ness, look no further than the Lenovo U41-70.

The ASUS X555LJ is at the other end of the performance spectrum compared to the Lenovo U41. With NVIDIA GeForce 920M graphics and 6 gigs of RAM, and commendable battery life of 3 hours and 25 minutes in our battery benchmark test, the ASUS hands down beats all other laptops in this comparison when it comes to performance alone. Just take a look at the mag table and some of its benchmark

And like the HP and Lenovo laptops, the ASUS machine is also a looker, which is a pleasant surprise. Overall, a great machine, the ASUS one, at an attractive price.

WINNERS

No surprises for guessing the Best Performer Award here as it goes to the ASUS X555LJ, a deserving winner. As far as the Best Buy Award goes, the HP 15-AF001AX deserves it more than anyone else, as it does a great job of offering so



The ASUS X555LJ beats the rest of the competition easily to bag the Best Performer Award this month. A deserving winner!

scores – great to see them in a laptop available for under 40k. Gaming capability isn't great but not too bad either on this laptop. Watching movies is great as well, largely due to the SonicMaster audio built-in that helps provide better-than-average audio experience, compared to most other laptops at this price point. Its major drawback is its screen's contrast ratio which, like the HP laptops, isn't anything to boast about. However, despite packing in so much firepower, the ASUS laptop ran relatively cool with temps averaging in the mid-50 degrees at peak load, which is very good news indeed.

much at so little a cost. And the laptop is proof that AMD-powered machines, at least at the budget end of the market, are more than capable of taking on their Intel-powered counterparts. We would definitely like to see more OEMs sporting AMD machines for price-sensitive customers. No Editor's Pick? That's right. This reviewer tried very hard to decide between the two Acers, HP and Lenovo laptops, to see if anyone of them deserved a special mention. But due to lack of overwhelming unique features, we think there's very little to separate them, and so rest our case. **d**